APA

Lesson with Daniel E. Zawacki (Mr. Z)

Welcome!

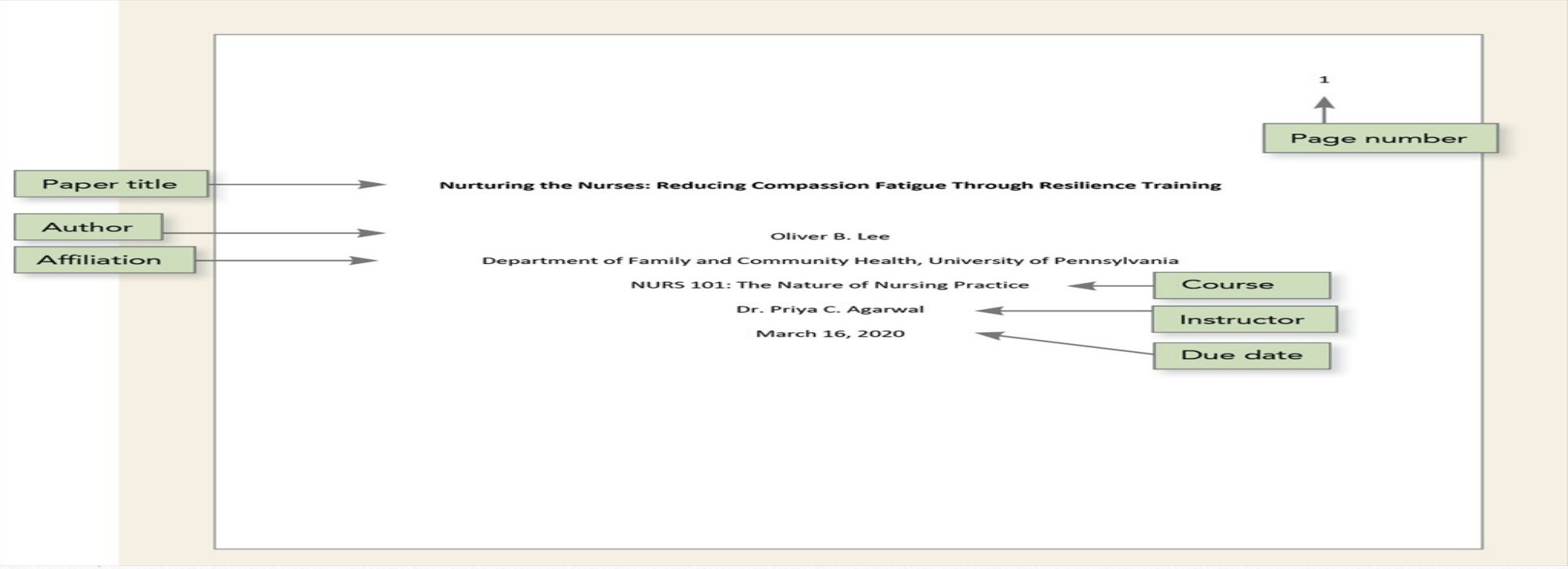
For those of you who do not know, APA stands for American Psychological Association.

MLA

Modern Language Association

AP = Associated Press

APA Title Page



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APA Headings and Subheadings

Level 1

Elements of Literature

Elements of literature or literary elements are the components of a literary work. A literary work is a branch of literature that involves the use of words to create an idea, a picture, or a story in a meaningful pattern. Literary elements are there to help in the discussion and understanding of literary works.

Level 2

Plot

The plot of a literary work is the order of events that takes place, where each plot affects the next from the beginning of the story to the end.

English novelist, E.M Forster argued that a plot doesn't just describe a random event like a story does but instead it describes the cause and effect.

Level 3

Conflict

The conflict of a story is the problem that the main characters have to tend to. The two types of conflicts that exist in a plot are major conflicts and minor conflicts.

In-text citation for quotes

Always make sure to include Author, Date, and Page Number when including parenthetical citation for a direct quote.

(Jones, 2023, p. 23)

In-text citation of paraphrases

There is nothing wrong with putting something in your own words, as long as you do not distort the meaning. In addition, make sure you include proper in-text citation for the paraphrase, which includes author and year.

(Martin, 2023)

Signal Phrases

Never jam a quote into your work. Have a variety of Signal Phrases ready to go. For example:

According to Zawacki (2019),

Smith(2023) claims

In a recent study by The Cleveland Clinic (2024),

Brackets

No, we are not talking March Madness brackets here. All kidding aside, brackets [ ] are used to insert a little information when working with a direct quote. For example:

[…] When you omit content in a quote

[sic] When there is a spelling error in a quote

If you feel the need to clarify who or what something is. For example:

“The ADA [Americans with Disabilities Act] prohibits discrimination against those with disabilities.”

References

The References page is an alphabetized list of any source your paraphrased or quoted in your paper. It needs a hanging indent and has some special, some might even say, counterintuitive formatting requirements.

Grady, J. S., Her, M., Moreno, G., Perez, C., & Yelinek, J. (2019). Emotions in storybooks: A comparison of storybooks that represent ethnic and racial groups in the United States. *Psychology of Popular Media Culture*, *8*(3), 207–217. https://doi.org/10.1037/ppm0000185

Works Consulted

A Works Consulted page is a special section used to house sources you literally consulted but did not use. Professors usually make this optional. According to APA, if someone is going to include a Works Consulted page, it should appear as an Appendix Item.

What is an Appendix?

An organ?

In all seriousness, it is a section of a paper or a published work that is too lengthy or detailed to include within the text. In the past, there used to be a greater emphasis on placing visual elements like charts and graphs in an Appendix rather than within the text.

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Questions????

Font

- A variety of fonts are permitted in APA Style papers. Font options include the following:
- **sans serif fonts** such as 11-point Calibri, 11-point Arial, or 10-point Lucida Sans Unicode
- **serif fonts** such as 12-point Times New Roman, 11-point Georgia, or normal (10-point) Computer Modern

Spacing

Use double spacing when you are submitting a written assignment in APA format. This makes it much easier for the instructor to give feedback on a hard copy or electronic submission.

Subheadings

Subheadings always trip up students, as least they did with me when I was first adapting to APA. Use them wisely. They can be used to indicate what a paragraph or even what a group of paragraphs is about. For instance,

Introduction (optional)

Patient Demographic

Treatment Options

Conclusion

Word Usage

DOUBLE LETTER SCORE
DOUBLE WORD SCORE
TRIPLE LETTER SCORE
TRIPLE WORD SCORE

Diction

In short, Diction means word usage, which refers to choice, delivery, and pronunciation. In TRW, we are more concerned with Choice. With that being said, there are bad habits one must avoid.

→

1. Contractions

Can’t, don’t, isn’t, don’t, you’d are just a few
Contractions are frowned upon since they ar
shorthand during spoken communication. U
is using one in a direct quote, avoid them.

Contraction Bingo

B	I	N	G	O
can’t	I'll	we’ve	won’t	wasn’t
don’t	wasn’t	can’t	don’t	I'll
didn’t	we’re	won’t	can’t	we’re
isn’t	you’ll	didn’t	isn’t	don’t
won’t	you’d	isn’t	didn’t	you’ll

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2. Clichés

Clichés are tired and old expressions that lack originality. More often than not, they are examples of Figurative Language rather than Literal Language. In Science Writing, one must be more

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3. Informal Language

kid: A baby goat or antelope, not a child, teen, or young adult.

stuff/thing: Way too vague. Be more

a lot: a place to park a car or piece of l
Not to be used for a house, not for qua

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4. Slang

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Any informal language that is temporary or dated, is considered to be Slang. Once again, think literal instead of figurative.

Examples include: for a minute, lowkey, yeah no, bummer, messed up, freaked out, throw under the bus…the list goes on.

Being Concise

Sometimes less is more!

Yeah, I know I am being cliché and a bit of a hypocrite now. However, in science writing, one must be direct and concise. For instance, see the examples below:

Due to the fact that OR
Since

In today's day and age
Currently

In the month of March
In March

Tips from the pros

- Read you drafts aloud. You will be surprised how many errors and issues you detect, just by reading your draft out loud. I have been doing this for decades.
- Read them backwards? By backwards, I mean start with the last paragraph first and work your way to the title page. More often than not, we read drafts the way we want them to be in our heads rather than read them how they actually are. With that being said, we have to trick our brains a bit.

Lastly

Help is just an email away!

Before/after class.

THE
END